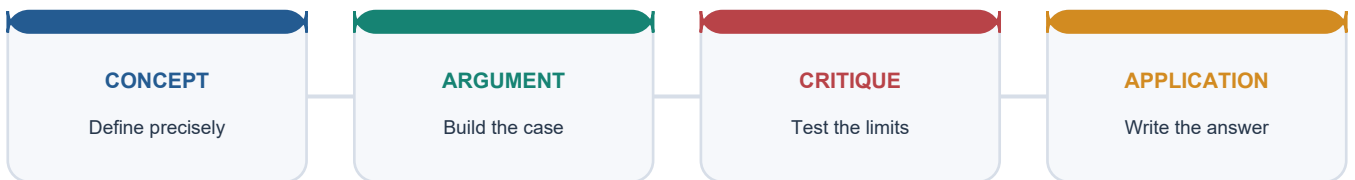


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Colonial and Post-Independence Architecture - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Colonial and Post-Independence Architecture - Solved Practice Workbook

This standalone workbook carries exactly 32 original MCQs with strict ABCD rotation, the honest Topic 05 PYQ audit, one routed boundary note and six full original Mains answers.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

CORE UPSC MCQS

Q1. Which statement best captures the safest way to study colonial architecture in India?

A. It should be read as a programme of ports, forts, churches, courts, capitals and public monuments through which power organised urban space. B. It is mainly a decorative story and city planning can be ignored. C. All colonial powers used the same style, so chronology matters little. D. Only post-1911 New Delhi belongs to colonial architecture.

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It should be read as a programme of ports, forts, churches, courts, capitals and public monuments through which power organised urban space. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q2. Which of the following is the clearest French contribution described in the source spine?

A. Baroque church design combined with patio houses B. Cartesian grid planning and restrained facades in towns like Puducherry and Chandernagore C. The upturned dome of post-1911 New Delhi D. Filler slab construction for low-cost housing

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Cartesian grid planning and restrained facades in towns like Puducherry and Chandernagore The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q3. Which set is correctly matched with British Indo-Gothic / colonial Indo-Saracenic architecture?

A. Basilica of Bom Jesus and Se Cathedral B. Puducherry grid and Chandernagore grid C. Victoria Memorial, St. Paul's Cathedral, Madras High Court and Mysore Palace D. Rashtrapati Bhavan and the Secretariat blocks only

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Victoria Memorial, St. Paul's Cathedral, Madras High Court and Mysore Palace The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q4. Which statement about the Portuguese phase is correct?

A. Se Cathedral was completed in 1905 as a marble memorial. B. Diu Fort belongs to the French grid-planning phase. C. Portuguese influence in India avoided churches and relied only on warehouses. D. Portuguese architecture combined fortified coastal settlements with churches, patio houses and Baroque design.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Portuguese architecture combined fortified coastal settlements with churches, patio houses and Baroque design. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q5. Which monument is the safest Baroque anchor in Portuguese Goa?

A. Basilica of Bom Jesus B. St. Paul's Cathedral, Kolkata C. Old Parliament House, New Delhi D. Madhya Pradesh Assembly Building

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Basilica of Bom Jesus The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q6. Which option correctly describes the source's use of the term 'anonymous architecture'?

A. It refers to buildings without any historical importance. B. It refers to simple facades without much ornamentation in the French colonial context. C. It refers to buildings whose architects are unknown in post-independence India. D. It refers to demolished twentieth-century buildings such as Hall of Nations.

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It refers to simple facades without much ornamentation in the French colonial context. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q7. Which statement is the safest distinction between colonial Indo-Saracenic and topic 04's Indo-Islamic architecture?

A. Both are exactly the same and need no period qualification. B. Colonial Indo-Saracenic rejected all Indian motifs. C. Colonial Indo-Saracenic is a British revival hybrid using Gothic structures with selected Indian features, whereas topic 04 owns the medieval Indo-Islamic synthesis. D. Topic 04 owns only mosques while topic 05 owns all domed structures.

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Colonial Indo-Saracenic is a British revival hybrid using Gothic structures with selected Indian features, whereas topic 04 owns the medieval Indo-Islamic synthesis. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q8. Which statement about presidency-city evidence is correct?

A. Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco property is a single monument designed in 1927. B. Kolkata has no secure British memorial anchor in the topic owner's evidence. C. Madras High Court belongs to the Portuguese coastal phase. D. Mumbai is safest when handled as an urban ensemble, while Kolkata gives named anchors such as Victoria Memorial and St. Paul's Cathedral.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Mumbai is safest when handled as an urban ensemble, while Kolkata gives named anchors such as Victoria Memorial and St. Paul's Cathedral. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q9. Which feature-set is most closely associated with British Indo-Gothic architecture in the topic?

A. Pointed arches, ribbed vaults, stained glass, domes, jaali and turrets B. Filler slab, rat-trap bond and low-cost housing C. Double-skinned roofs, sunscreens and reflecting pools D. Only plain circular buildings without ornament

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Pointed arches, ribbed vaults, stained glass, domes, jaali and turrets The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q10. Which statement correctly identifies the post-1911 New Delhi phase?

A. It was led by French planners at Chandernagore. B. It used Neo-Roman or Neo-Classical architecture under Edwin Lutyens and Herbert Baker. C. It was the first great example of Laurie Baker's low-cost design. D. It replaced all monumental state planning with purely vernacular housing.

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It used Neo-Roman or Neo-Classical architecture under Edwin Lutyens and Herbert Baker. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q11. Which interpretation best explains architecture as colonial power?

A. Only churches mattered politically; civic and capital buildings did not. B. Architecture mattered solely for art history, not for rule. C. Churches, grids, memorials, courts and capitals organised public space and made authority visible. D. Colonial architecture became political only after 1947.

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Churches, grids, memorials, courts and capitals organised public space and made authority visible. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q12. Which statement about the 1927 Parliament building is safest?

A. Its design was conclusively proved by official records to be copied from Mitaoli. B. It was designed by Bimal Patel for the Central Vista project. C. It was demolished after the new Parliament was opened. D. It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q13. Which statement best uses the source's post-1947 critique?

A. The book treats both schools as carrying a colonial hangover, so answers must weigh continuity and change together. B. Both Revivalist and Modernist schools fully escaped colonial inheritance at once. C. There was no meaningful architecture in India after 1947. D. Only the Revivalist school carried colonial influence; the Modernists did not.

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: The book treats both schools as carrying a colonial hangover, so answers must weigh continuity and change together. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q14. Which example best represents the paradox of imported modernism serving an Indian state project?

A. Victoria Memorial B. Chandigarh designed by Le Corbusier for the Punjab government C. Diu Fort D. Church of the Sacred Heart of Jesus, Puducherry

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Chandigarh designed by Le Corbusier for the Punjab government The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q15. According to UNESCO's Le Corbusier property page, which cluster belongs to the Capitol Complex's climate response?

A. Golden Bell, patio houses and coastal churches B. Filler slabs, rat-trap bond and low-cost brick housing C. Sunscreens, double-skinned roofs and reflecting pools for natural air-conditioning and air cooling D. Pointed arches, stained glass and ribbed vaults

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Sunscreens, double-skinned roofs and reflecting pools for natural air-conditioning and air cooling The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q16. Which statement about G.B. Deolalikar is correct?

A. He designed Chandigarh for the Punjab government. B. He was awarded the 2018 Pritzker Prize. C. He is the verified architect of Hall of Nations. D. He is used in the topic as the architect of the Supreme Court of India (1958), an early major Indian state commission.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: He is used in the topic as the architect of the Supreme Court of India (1958), an early major Indian state commission. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q17. Which statement is the safest about Charles Correa and Achyut Kanvinde?

A. Correa worked through civic and assembly planning, while Kanvinde is linked to modern and Brutalist institutional projects such as IIT Kanpur and the National Science Centre. B. Both are merely decorative revivalists with no institutional work. C. Correa designed only private residences and Kanvinde only temples. D. Both are best remembered as colonial architects before 1911.

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Correa worked through civic and assembly planning, while Kanvinde is linked to modern and Brutalist institutional projects such as IIT Kanpur and the National Science Centre. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q18. Which of the following most accurately describes Laurie Baker's contribution?

A. He is important mainly because he proved the Mitaoli inspiration for Parliament. B. He used local materials, filler slabs, ventilation and thermal comfort to reshape low-cost housing in Kerala. C. He designed Victoria Memorial in white marble. D. He won the Pritzker Prize in 2006.

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: He used local materials, filler slabs, ventilation and thermal comfort to reshape low-cost housing in Kerala. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q19. Which statement about B.V. Doshi is correct?

A. He received Padma Vibhushan in 2020. B. His verified named works in the topic exclude housing and climate-sensitive campuses. C. He won the 2018 Pritzker Architecture Prize and is the first Indian laureate. D. He is presented only through unverified newspaper reports.

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: He won the 2018 Pritzker Architecture Prize and is the first Indian laureate. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q20. Which option correctly matches Doshi's verified award sequence?

A. Padma Shri 1976, Padma Vibhushan 2020, Padma Bhushan 2023 B. Padma Bhushan 1976, Padma Shri 2020, Padma Vibhushan 2023 C. Only the 2018 Pritzker is verified; no Padma award is safely known D. Padma Shri 1976, Padma Bhushan 2020, Padma Vibhushan 2023 (posthumous)

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Padma Shri 1976, Padma Bhushan 2020, Padma Vibhushan 2023 (posthumous) The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q21. Which statement about Raj Rewal should be retained?

A. His bounded evidence base centres on Hall of Nations and Asian Games Village, and no Padma or Pritzker award should be attributed to him here. B. He received a verified Padma Shri in 1989 for Hall of Nations. C. His safest use here is as an award-winning architect with a fully official prize list. D. His works fall outside architectural history because they are too recent.

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: His bounded evidence base centres on Hall of Nations and Asian Games Village, and no Padma or Pritzker award should be attributed to him here. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q22. Why is Hall of Nations important in this topic?

A. It proves all modern buildings receive strong automatic protection in India. B. It shows how an important post-independence building can become a modern-heritage vulnerability and conservation controversy. C. It is the source's main example of Portuguese Baroque design. D. It was designed by Louis Kahn as part of IIM Ahmedabad.

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It shows how an important post-independence building can become a modern-heritage vulnerability and conservation controversy. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q23. Which statement about the new Parliament building is correct?

A. It was designed by Herbert Baker and entered service in 1927. B. It is officially treated as proof that the Mitaoli inspiration claim is historically settled. C. It was designed by Bimal Patel and inaugurated in 2023 as part of the Central Vista redevelopment. D. Its opening required demolition of the old Parliament building.

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It was designed by Bimal Patel and inaugurated in 2023 as part of the Central Vista redevelopment. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q24. Which statement is safest about Samvidhan Sadan?

A. It is the new name of the Chandigarh Capitol Complex. B. It is the official name of the Hall of Nations after restoration. C. It refers to St. Paul's Cathedral after conservation. D. It is the old Parliament building retained after the shift to the new Parliament.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It is the old Parliament building retained after the shift to the new Parliament. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q25. Which statement most safely uses Mumbai's UNESCO ensemble in Topic 05?

A. It shows two urban expansions: Victorian Gothic public buildings and later Art Deco / Indo-Deco blocks facing each other across the Oval Maidan. B. It proves colonial Bombay had only Gothic buildings and no later phase. C. It should be ignored because it belongs only to heritage law, not architecture. D. It is a temple-complex property that settles the Parliament-Mitaoli debate.

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It shows two urban expansions: Victorian Gothic public buildings and later Art Deco / Indo-Deco blocks facing each other across the Oval Maidan. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q26. Which statement about Louis Kahn is safest within this topic's verified evidence?

A. He designed the new Parliament building in 2023. B. He is securely present as one of the influences named in Doshi's official Pritzker citation, and his IIM Ahmedabad campus survives as a conservation case through official restoration records. C. He is the architect of Diu Fort. D. He received Padma Vibhushan in 2006 for Indian public architecture.

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: He is securely present as one of the influences named in Doshi's official Pritzker citation, and his IIM Ahmedabad campus survives as a conservation case through official restoration records. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q27. Why is the IIM Ahmedabad restoration case useful here?

A. It proves all modern architecture can be restored without institutional effort. B. It belongs only to medieval history because of exposed brick arches. C. It demonstrates an official conservation effort for a major modern campus, reminding us that modern architecture also requires restoration, testing and phased repair. D. It disproves Doshi's connection with Louis Kahn.

Answer: C. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It demonstrates an official conservation effort for a major modern campus, reminding us that modern architecture also requires restoration, testing and phased repair. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q28. Which concluding line is best for a Mains answer on post-independence architecture?

A. After 1947, India immediately found one fully indigenous style and the debate ended. B. Post-independence architecture mattered only in Chandigarh and nowhere else. C. The topic can be answered entirely through awards without buildings. D. The safest verdict is that post-1947 architecture negotiated colonial inheritance unevenly, with the clearest breaks appearing where architects changed climate logic, social client and institutional use.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: The safest verdict is that post-1947 architecture negotiated colonial inheritance unevenly, with the clearest breaks appearing where architects changed climate logic, social client and institutional use. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q29. Which statement about Baker and Doshi is correct?

A. Baker was nominated for the Pritzker in 2006, while Doshi won it in 2018. B. Both won the Pritzker Prize together in 2018. C. Doshi was only nominated and Baker was the first Indian winner. D. Neither has any verified link with low-cost housing in the topic.

Answer: A. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Baker was nominated for the Pritzker in 2006, while Doshi won it in 2018. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q30. Which is the strongest comparative statement about colonial and post-independence architecture?

A. Colonial architecture had power and planning, while post-independence architecture had only housing. B. Colonial architecture organised authority through forts, churches, courts and capitals, while post-independence architecture retained monumental state form but also developed new responses to climate, cost and social use. C. Colonial architecture disappeared completely after 1947. D. The two periods are identical in sponsor, symbolism and client.

Answer: B. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: Colonial architecture organised authority through forts, churches, courts and capitals, while post-independence architecture retained monumental state form but also developed new responses to climate, cost and social use. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

Q31. Which statement should be avoided in this topic?

A. The Mitaoli link to the 1927 Parliament building is debated, not documentary certainty. B. Raj Rewal's award record should be left blank unless officially verified. C. The new Parliament building proves beyond doubt that its circular vocabulary was copied from Mitaoli. D. Mumbai's UNESCO property is an urban ensemble, not one monument.

Answer: C. Explanation: C is selected because it is the unsafe and false statement. The Mitaoli resemblance is debated only for the 1927 Parliament building and must not be transferred to the 2023 new Parliament building as proof of copying. A, B and D are the safe control statements for this topic.

Q32. Which summary statement best closes Topic 05?

A. The topic is a random list of European monuments and modern awards. B. It should be merged fully into topic 04 because all domed buildings belong together. C. Only official UNESCO sites matter; all other buildings can be ignored. D. It is best understood as a movement from colonial urban programmes and public styles to post-independence debates over climate, cost, state symbolism and modern heritage.

Answer: D. Explanation: The correct option is the only one that fits the topic's chronology, attribution and boundary control here: It is best understood as a movement from colonial urban programmes and public styles to post-independence debates over climate, cost, state symbolism and modern heritage. The distractors instead shift the answer to another phase, architect, building type or unsafe claim.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

OWNED PYQ STATUS

- Verified routed ledgers for this topic currently yield **zero direct GS-I Mains PYQs** securely owned by Topic 05.
- The same audited route yields **zero securely owned objective/application PYQs** for Topic 05 in the present repository spine.
- A related but **not-owned** objective route is the **2021 Prelims GS-I Q35** on the Chausath Yogini Temple near Morena. Topic 03 owns that temple question; Topic 05 owns only the caution that the Parliament-Mitaoli link must remain a debated resemblance rather than documentary certainty.

ROUTED BOUNDARY NOTE - 2021 PRELIMS GS-I Q35

Question (locally reproducible from a source-book scan): With reference to Chausath Yogini Temple situated near Morena, consider the following statements:

1. It is a circular temple built during the reign of the Kachchhapaghata dynasty.
2. It is the only circular temple built in India.
3. It was meant to promote the Vaishnava sect in the region.
4. Its design has given rise to a popular belief that it was the inspiration behind the Indian Parliament building.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Not solved in Topic 05. Boundary analysis: The temple, chronology and answer key belong to Topic 03 on Temple Architecture. Topic 05 reuses only one caution from that route: statement 4 should be handled as a **popular belief** /

debated resemblance, not as proven documentary genealogy for the 1927 Parliament building, and certainly not as a claim about the 2023 Parliament building.

ORIGINAL MAINS ANSWER 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why should colonial architecture in India be read as a programme of urban control rather than as a mere sequence of imported styles? (Answer in 150 words)

Model answer: Colonial architecture in India is best read as a programme of urban control because each colonial power built institutions, not just facades. The Portuguese linked churches, patio houses and forts to maritime rule; the French used Cartesian grids and restrained facades to discipline colonial towns; and the British developed public monuments, courts, memorials and finally a full imperial capital in New Delhi. Thus architecture organised space, authority and visibility.

The point becomes sharper when public-building types are named. Victoria Memorial monumentalised imperial memory, Madras High Court represented judicial power, and Lutyens-Baker's New Delhi converted state authority into axial urban form. A strong answer should conclude that colonial architecture mattered because it planned how people saw and entered power, not because it simply imported foreign ornament.

Why this answer works: It turns style into city function and state visibility.

ORIGINAL MAINS ANSWER 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish British Indo-Gothic architecture from post-1911 Neo-Classical imperial Delhi. (Answer in 150 words)

Model answer: British Indo-Gothic, also called colonial Indo-Saracenic in this topic, belongs mainly to the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. Its feature-set combines Gothic Revival elements such as pointed arches, ribbed vaults and stained glass with Indian devices like bulbous domes, jaali, balconies and turrets. Victoria Memorial, St. Paul's Cathedral and Madras High Court are the safest illustrations.

Post-1911 imperial Delhi belongs to a later phase. Under Edwin Lutyens and Herbert Baker, the British Raj shifted to Neo-Roman or Neo-Classical capital building. The emphasis here is on axial planning, monumentality, circularity and the 'Rome of Hindustan' effect rather than the earlier Gothic frame. Therefore the difference is not only stylistic but urban: Indo-Gothic marks colonial public architecture across cities, while post-1911 architecture monumentalises the capital itself.

Why this answer works: It gives period, features, examples and the city-scale distinction.

ORIGINAL MAINS ANSWER 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Chandigarh marks both a rupture and a continuity in post-Independence Indian architecture. Discuss. (Answer in 250 words)

Model answer: Chandigarh marks rupture because it broke with the revivalist and imperial vocabularies of colonial architecture. Commissioned after Partition to serve the Punjab government, it offered a new capital in the language of modernism rather than Gothic revival or Lutyens-style classicism. UNESCO's account of the Capitol Complex strengthens this reading by describing it as a site that symbolised India's accession to modernity and influenced the wider subcontinent.

Yet Chandigarh also marks continuity. The state still expressed itself through monumental public architecture, planned avenues and a concentrated administrative core. In that sense, political independence did not abolish the capital-building impulse inherited from colonial rule. The very fact that a foreign architect, Le Corbusier, was hired for the task complicates any simple claim of instant architectural decolonisation.

The deeper significance lies in adaptation. UNESCO notes the use of sunscreens, double-skinned roofs and reflecting pools for natural air-conditioning and energy saving. This shows that the project was not a climate-blind import. Thus Chandigarh should be judged as a post-colonial negotiation: a break from colonial style and a continuation of monumental state planning, modified through modernist technique and climatic response.

Why this answer works: It balances rupture, continuity and climate evidence instead of praising Chandigarh uncritically.

ORIGINAL MAINS ANSWER 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: How did post-1947 Indian architects attempt to make modern architecture more Indian? Discuss with suitable examples. (Answer in 250 words)

Model answer: Post-1947 Indian architects made modern architecture more Indian not by rejecting modernism altogether, but by reworking it through climate, institution and social client. Charles Correa adapted modern principles to local sensibilities through projects such as the Madhya Pradesh Assembly Building and the Mahatma Gandhi Memorial Museum. His strength lies in civic planning, courtyards and open-to-sky spatial logic. Achyut Kanvinde addressed another problem - the new republic's institutional needs - through projects like IIT Kanpur and the National Science Centre, using a more severe modern and Brutalist language.

Laurie Baker took the most radical step by changing the client and cost structure of architecture. His Kerala housing work used local materials, filler slab construction, ventilation and thermal comfort to produce low-cost humane building. B.V. Doshi expanded the field further. The Pritzker citation's examples - Aranya, Sangath and IIM Bangalore - show a modernism reorganised around community, courts, galleries and hot-climate adaptation.

Therefore, Indianisation did not mean one official national style. It meant different responses to Indian conditions: civic openness in Correa, institutional mass in Kanvinde, low-cost climate logic in Baker and community-scaled regional modernism in Doshi.

Why this answer works: It avoids a mere name list and explains the specific problem each architect answered.

ORIGINAL MAINS ANSWER 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Trace the development of architecture in India from the colonial presidency cities to post-Independence national architecture. (Answer in 250 words)

Model answer: The development of modern architecture in India can be traced through three linked phases: colonial urban programmes, imperial capital monumentalism and post-Independence experiments in national architecture. The colonial presidency cities form the first phase. Portuguese Goa and Diu joined Baroque churches, patio houses and forts to coastal control. French Puducherry and Chandernagore translated power into Cartesian planning. British rule then expanded the scale of public architecture through Indo-Gothic or colonial Indo-Saracenic forms used for cathedrals, courts, memorials and palaces. Victoria Memorial, St. Paul's Cathedral and Madras High Court are the clearest anchors.

The second phase begins with the 1911 capital transfer and the Neo-Classical or Neo-Roman architecture of Lutyens and Baker. New Delhi transformed public architecture into an imperial capital axis, with the 1927 Parliament building situated inside this larger symbolic plan.

The third phase is post-1947. The new republic first relied on Le Corbusier's Chandigarh for a dramatic modernist statement, then moved into Indian authorship through G.B. Deolalikar, Charles Correa, Achyut Kanvinde, Laurie Baker and B.V. Doshi. Here the vocabulary shifted from colonial prestige to problems of state institutions, climate, affordability and social use.

Thus, the line from presidency city to republic is not one of total rupture. It is a movement from colonial public power to Indian attempts at modern, climatic and socially responsive architecture.

Why this answer works: It preserves chronology while still allowing continuity and change to coexist.

ORIGINAL MAINS ANSWER 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Modern heritage in India demands a wider architectural imagination than ancient-monument thinking alone. Critically examine with reference to Raj Rewal, Louis Kahn's Indian campus legacy and the Parliament transition. (Answer in 250 words)

Model answer: Modern heritage in India requires a wider imagination because many significant twentieth-century buildings fall outside older public habits of heritage recognition. Raj Rewal's Hall of Nations is the clearest case. Built in 1972 and demolished in 2017, it shows that architectural significance alone does not guarantee protection when modern buildings are treated as expendable or when conservation systems remain antiquity-weighted. The same architect's Asian Games Village reminds us that post-Independence design also shaped everyday urban life, not only ceremonial monuments.

The Louis Kahn campus at IIM Ahmedabad adds a second dimension. Official restoration records show that the Vikram Sarabhai Library, Classroom Complex, Faculty Blocks and dormitories required measured drawings, condition mapping, testing and phased conservation. This proves that modern campuses need technical restoration, not just nostalgic admiration. Modern heritage is therefore a live maintenance and policy question.

The Parliament transition adds a third layer. The 1927 Parliament building was not erased after the 2023 inauguration of the new Parliament; it was retained as Samvidhan Sadan. This suggests one possible model of negotiated continuity. At the same time, the Mitaoli-influence claim must remain debated, not mythologised into proof.

A critical verdict is therefore necessary: India cannot protect modern architecture only when it becomes politically convenient or internationally famous. It must learn to value the recent architectural past as architecture, not merely as old age.

Why this answer works: It joins demolition, restoration and state continuity into one conservation argument.